SAVMUN

ST. DOMINIC SAVIO HIGH SCHOOL

BACKGROUNDGUIDE | GENERAL ASSEMBLY

LETTERS TO DELEGATES
FROM THE CHAIR

Dear Delegates,

Welcome to the General Assembly! My name is [Your Name], and I am so excited to be your Chair for this conference. I have been involved in Model UN since the beginning of high school, and I know how much fun it is to step into the shoes of world leaders.

Today, we are talking about one of the biggest challenges our world faces: climate change. We aren't just talking about the weather, we are talking about how changes in our planet affect real people, their homes, and their schools. As delegates, your job is to work together to find ways to help every community stay safe and healthy.

I encourage you to speak up, listen to each other, and remember that even though your countries might be different, we only have one earth to share. I can't wait to see the creative solutions you come up with!

Image of Chair

Best wishes,

[Your Name,] Chair

INTRODUCTION

The General Assembly is the main palace where all 193 member countries of the United Nations meet to talk about world problems. Climate change is a global problem, which means it doesn't stop at a country's borders. Because it affects everyone, the only way to fix it is through global cooperation, countries working as a team to share ideas, money, and technology. In this conference, delegates will be researching and discussing how to promote global cooperation to address climate change impacts on communities.

TOPIC:

Promoting Global Cooperation to Address Climate Change Impacts on Communities

STATEMENT OF THE PROBLEM

Our planet is getting warmer due to human activities, like burning fossil fuels (coal, oil, and gas) for energy. This warming is causing impacts or changes that hurt communities:

- Extreme Weather: Bigger storms and floods can destroy homes and schools.
- Health Risks: Very hot days (heatwaves) make it hard for kids and elderly people to stay healthy
- Food and Water: Droughts(long times without rain) make it hard for farmers to grow food, leading to hunger.

The biggest problem is that not every community has the money or tools to protect themselves. This is why we need to cooperate.

HISTORY OF THE PROBLEM

Countries have been trying to work together on climate change for a long time:

- 1992 Earth Summit: This was the first time countries met to agree that climate change was a serious problem.
- 2015 Paris Agreement: Almost every country in the world signed this. They promised to try to keep the Earth from getting too hot (limiting warming to 1.5℃) and to help poorer countries adapt to changes.

Even with these agreements, the Earth is still warming, and many communities are still in danger today.

CURRENT SITUATION

Right now, climate change is already changing how people live:

- School Disruptions: In 2024 alone, extreme weather stopped over 240 million students from going to school
- Moving Homes: Millions of people have had to leave their homes because of floods or rising sea levels. We call this displacement.
- Inequality: Poorer countries often suffer the most from climate change even though they didn't cause as much of the pollution.

QUESTIONS TO CONSIDER

- How can wealthy countries help poorer countries get the technology they need to stay safe?
- What can we do to make sure schools stay open and safe during extreme weather?
- How can countries share early warning systems so communities know a storm is coming before it hits?
- What are some ways your country can use clear energy (like sun or wind power) instead of fossil fuels?

LIST OF COUNTRIES (DELEGATION)

The Americas:
The United States
Brazil
Canada
Mexico
Jamaica

Europe:
Germany
The United Kingdom
France
Norway
Greece

Africa:
Nigeria
Egypt
South Africa
Kenya
Ethiopia

Asia and the Middle East:
China
India
Japan
Saudi Arabia
Indonesia

Oceania and Island Nations:
Australia
Fiji
Maldives
New Zealand
Philippines

KEY TERMS

- Climate Change: Long term changes in Earth's average weather and temperatures.
- Global cooperation: When countries work together to solve a problem that affects the whole world.
- Adaptation: Changing the way we live (like building stronger houses or planting different crops) to stay safe from climate impacts.
- Mitigation: Reducing the amount of greenhouse gases we put into the air to stop the planet from getting even warmer.
- Fossil Fuels: Natural sources of energy like coal and oil that releases gases when burned, causing the Earth to warm.

WORK CITED &
RESEARCH FOR STUDENTS:

- NASA Climate Kids: (Great for understanding the science of climate change).
- United Nations - Climate Action: (Explains what the UN is doing right now).
- The Paris Agreement Summary: (The main international law on climate change).
- National geographic Education: (Articles on how different communities are affected by global warming).